



Gaming in Goa: **ICGC National Finals**

A frenetic weekend with champions



Jayesh "Big Daddy" Shinde
feedback@skoar.com

In a sleepy resort off the tourist map, ICGC (Indian Cyber Gaming Championship) held its annual event in Goa, earlier last month. It was a final sprint to the finish line for a lot of good gamers competing from around the country. At stake were bragging rights, cash prizes, the title of national champions, and a chance to represent India in the international rounds of a few noteworthy competitions. What more could a self-respecting Indian gamer ask for?

The inauguration of the event was delayed a bit, but once they started the organizers wasted no time in getting right down to business. Organized by Nodwin Gaming, the ICGC Goa finale successfully staged and completed its three-day weekend gaming event, which saw over 400 gamers participate and congregate from all over the country. If not gaming against opponents in various knockout rounds or lounging around in the resort's two swimming pools (water polo!), the players of various clans were busy practicing their moves and tactics, strategizing on how to put their best foot forward.

However, there was precious little time to waste idling around or trying to explore Goa's weekend pleasures, as the gaming schedule was pretty intense, almost round the clock. There was plenty to keep the gamers busy and on their game as the day's gaming sessions – with simultaneous parallel sessions on different games – would start around noon and go non-stop all the way until 4 a.m. the next day. Battling sleep and weariness, energy drinks came to the gamers' rescue and were consumed by the dozen! Nothing prevented the show from going on.

The tournament featured games like DOTA, DOTA 2, FIFA 12, League of Legends, Battlefield 3, Counter Strike Global Offensive, Tekken Tag Tournament and Blur. Three of the games were on a console platform (PS3), while the other five were played on the PC. Participating in the event were some of India's elite gamers hailing from different parts of the country. In all, teams from 14 Indian cities, all competing for the ultimate prize: The chance to represent India in a global tournament of renowned gamers. How? For ICGC officially held the Indian legs of The Games Xpo (featuring DOTA 2) and the Electronic Sports World Cup (featuring FIFA 12 and

Tekken), winners of which would go on to compete internationally in Malaysia and Paris, respectively. We would like to congratulate Oblique Gaming (who won the DOTA 2 finals), Sagar Vyas (FIFA 12 winner) and Loveneet Dogra (Tekken Tag Tournament winner)

Attached along with the gaming tournament was an ancillary event, an expo of brands associated with the field of gaming – Alienware, Cooler Master, and Gunnar Optics. They had stalls to showcase their latest products and services to the gaming community.

The event organizers also made some encouraging announcements at ICGC's Goa event. The esports movement in India, which features gaming tournaments based on sports-based games, is moving closer towards recognition by the Indian Olympic Association, an important step which would help provide credibility to cyber athletes. ICGC also flagged off the Indian Pro Gaming House, a place where cyber athletes will be trained, prepped and coached along with paying them a salary, to bring professionalism into the Indian esports arena. All this will definitely help raise the profile of gaming in India. Can't hardly wait for the next ICGC finals? Neither can we! ✨